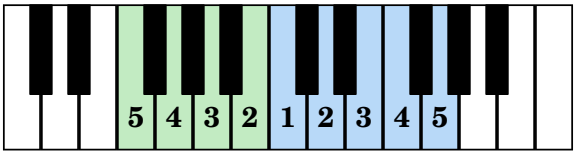
Unit 6

Middle C Position

New: Both thumbs on middle C; notes near the middle of the grand staff

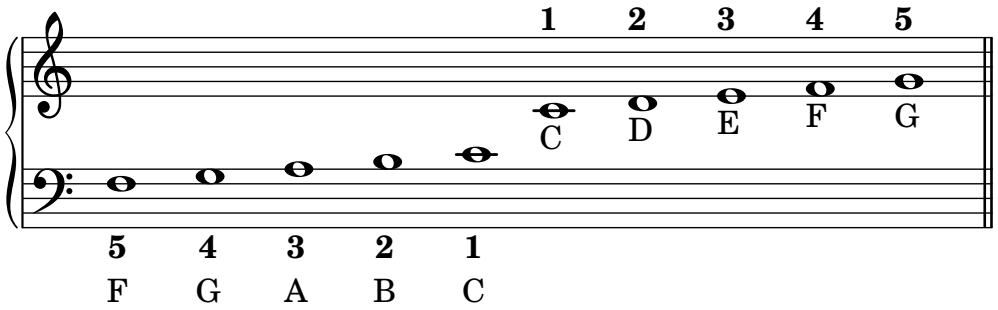
In the middle C position both thumbs share middle C. The right hand plays C D E F G as before. The left hand moves up so that fingers 5-4-3-2-1 sit on F G A B C, finishing on middle C. The hands are now right next to each other, and you read notes near the middle of the grand staff.



Middle C

Middle C position (LH) and Middle C position (RH) (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

One key, two ways to write it

Middle C can sit on a ledger line below the treble staff, or on a ledger line above the bass staff. It is the same key either way. The staff tells you which hand plays it.

New left-hand notes

F is the fourth line (between the clef's dots), G the top space, A the top line, B the space just above the staff, and C the ledger line above that.

Ledger lines

Short extra lines for notes beyond the staff. One ledger line above the bass staff, or below the treble staff, is middle C.

Reading tips

1. Don't confuse the top line of the bass staff (A) with the top space (G). Find the F line first and count up from it.

2. When the melody passes between the hands around middle C, the hands are next to each other. There is no jump.

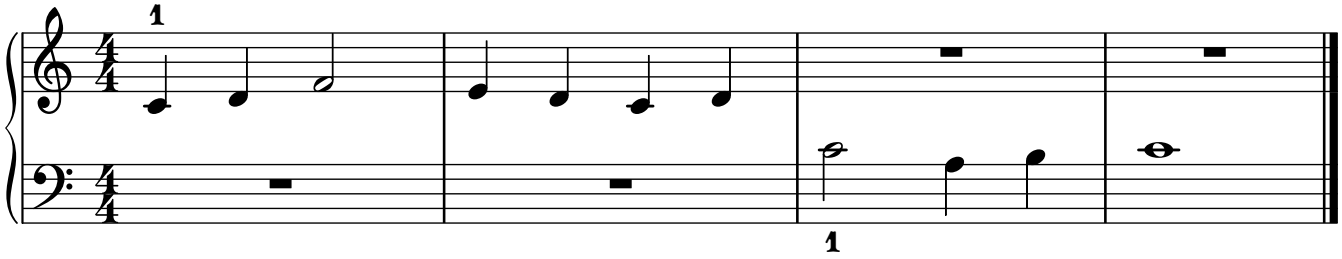
3. Middle C written on the bass staff means left thumb; written on the treble staff, right thumb.

4. Keep the beat going, and keep your eyes on the page.

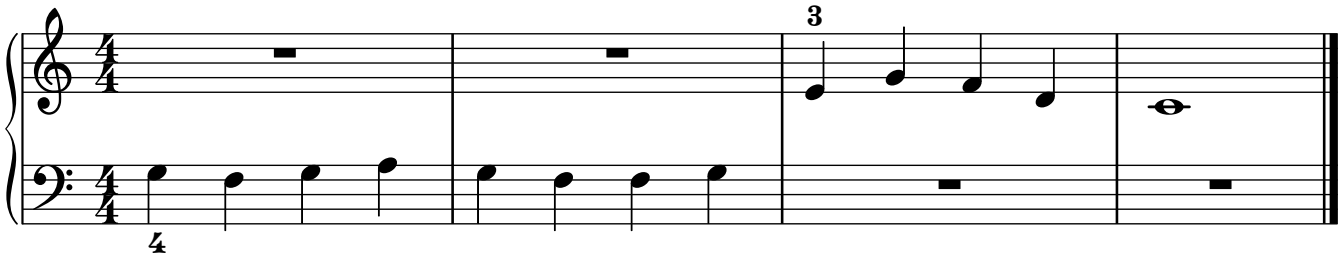
Part A: Reading across the middle ♩ = 60

Hands take turns across middle C. Metronome 60.

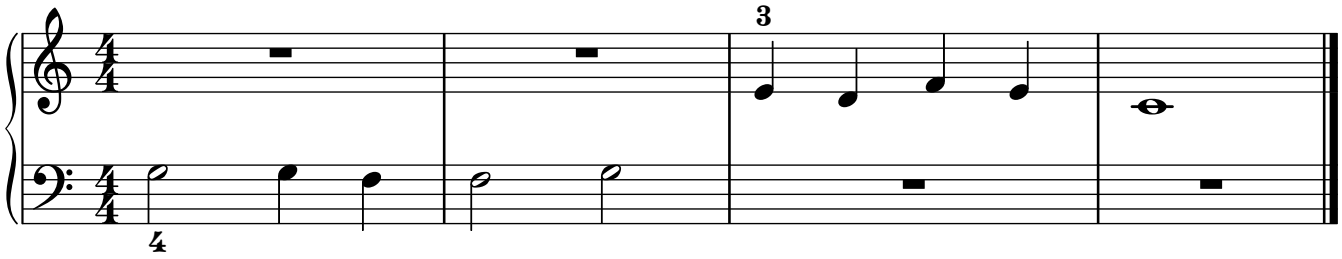
☐ **6.1**



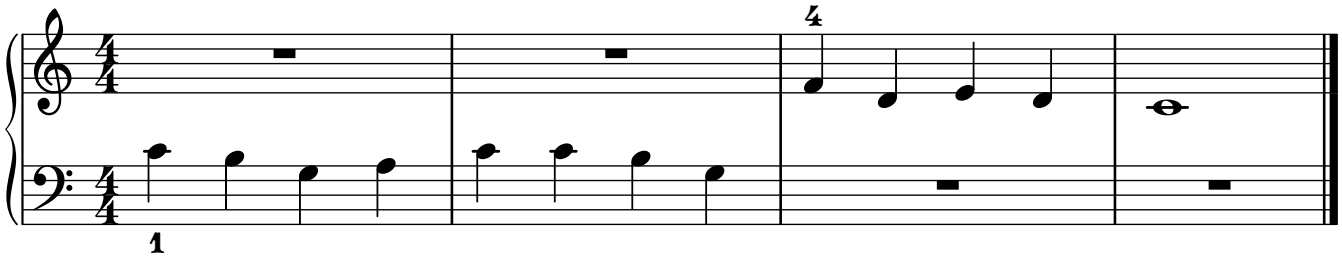
☐ **6.2**



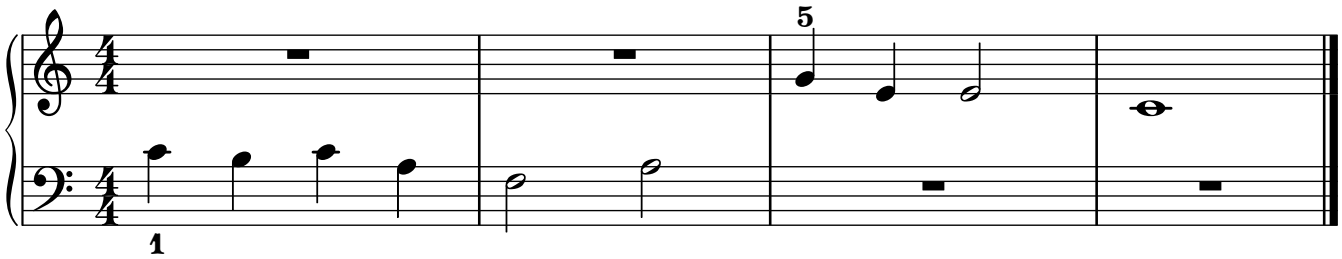
☐ **6.3**



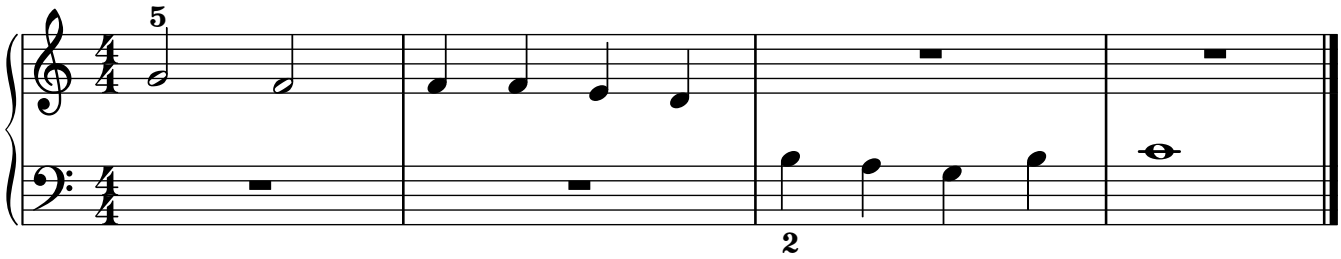
☐ **6.4**



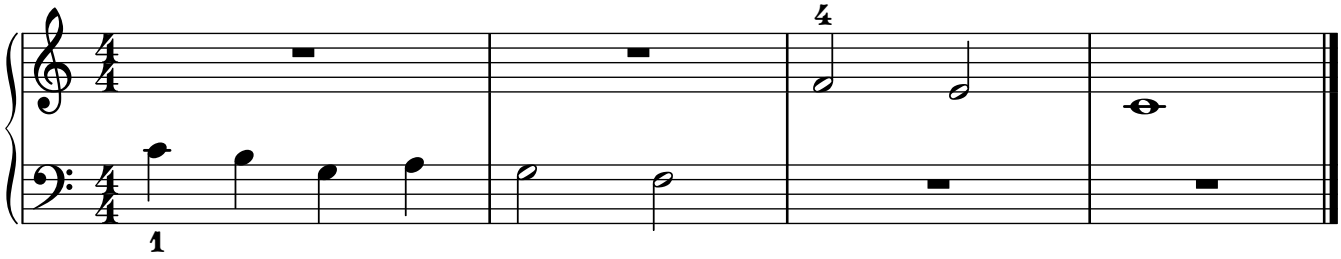
☐ **6.5**



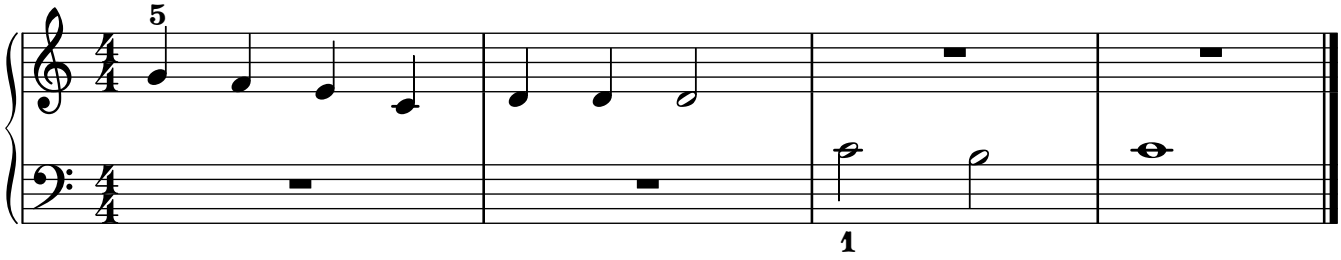
☐ **6.6**



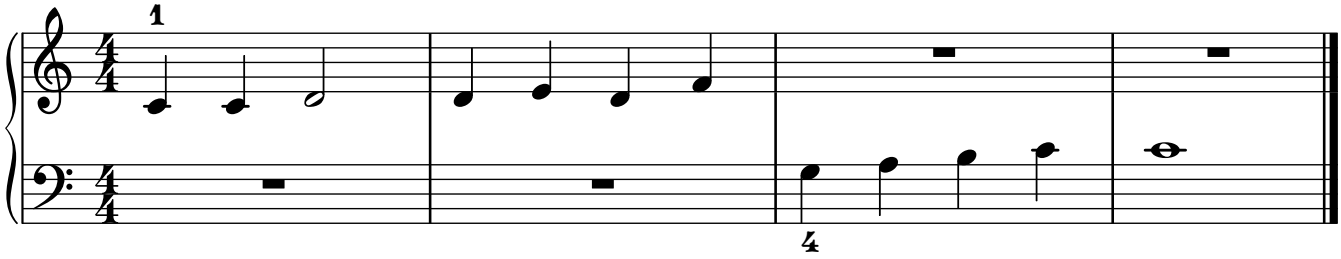
☐ **6.7**



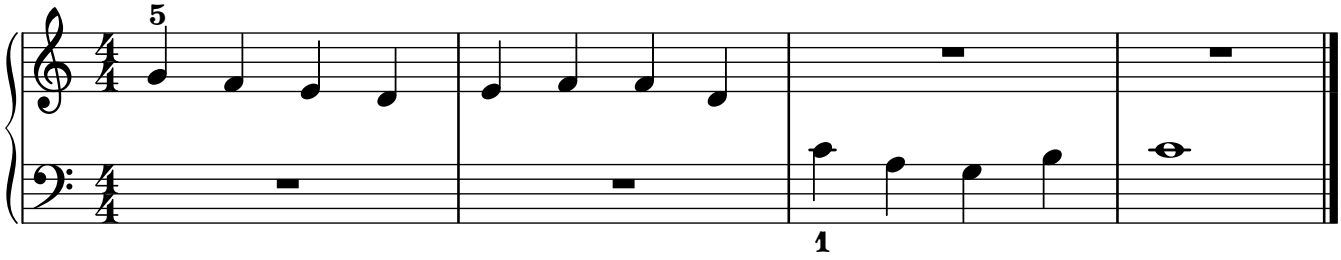
☐ **6.8**



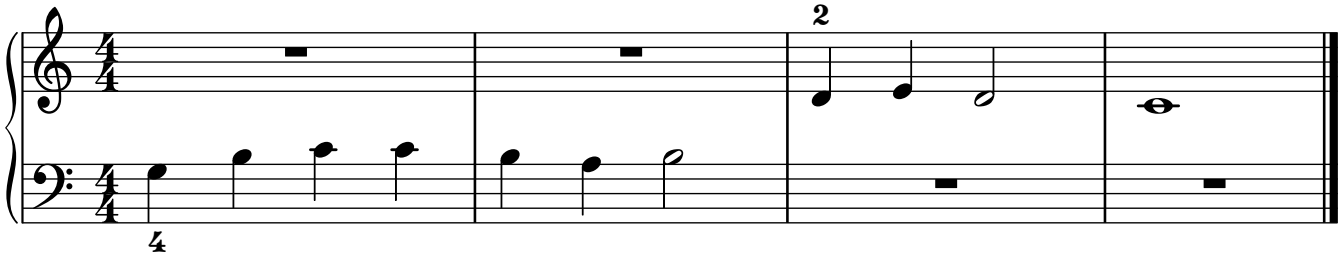
☐ **6.9**



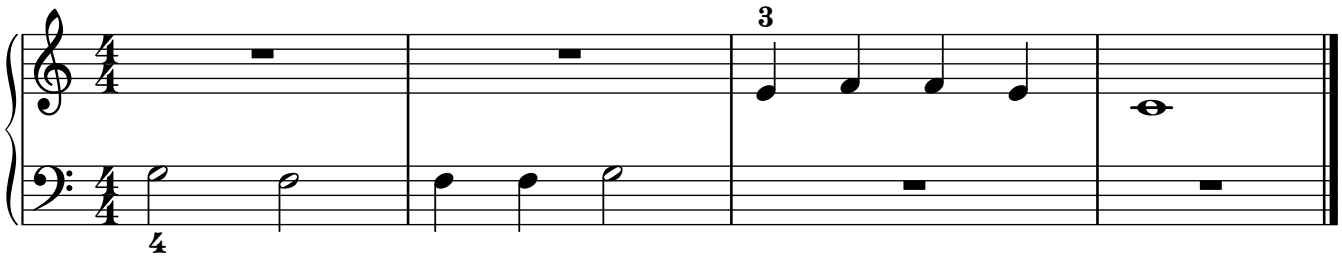
☐ **6.10**



☐ **6.11**



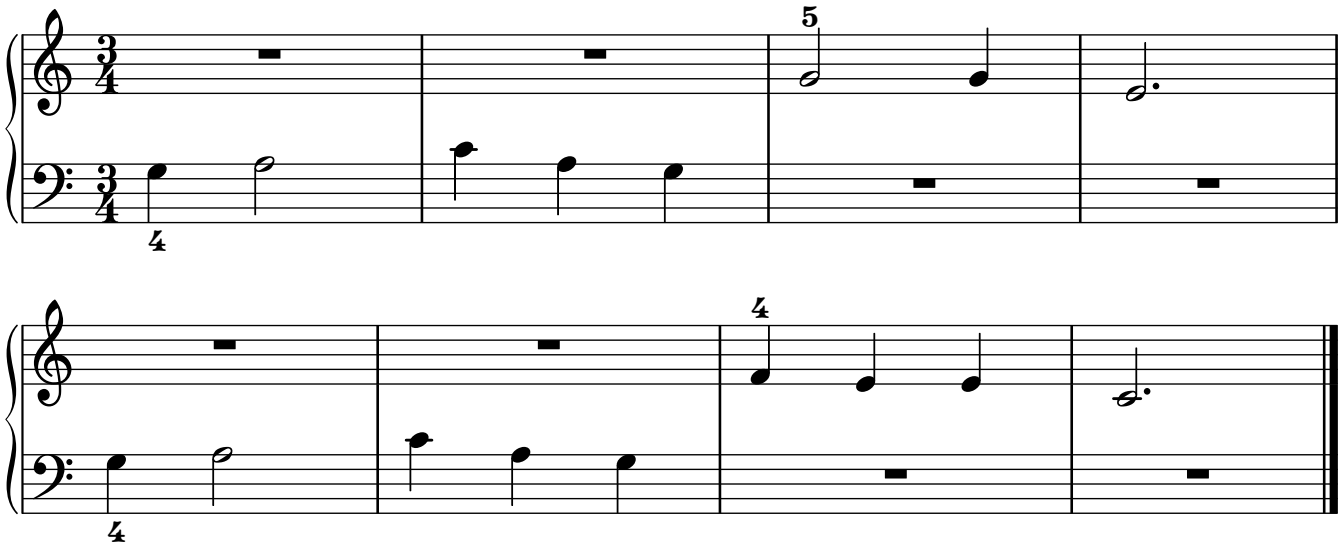
6.12



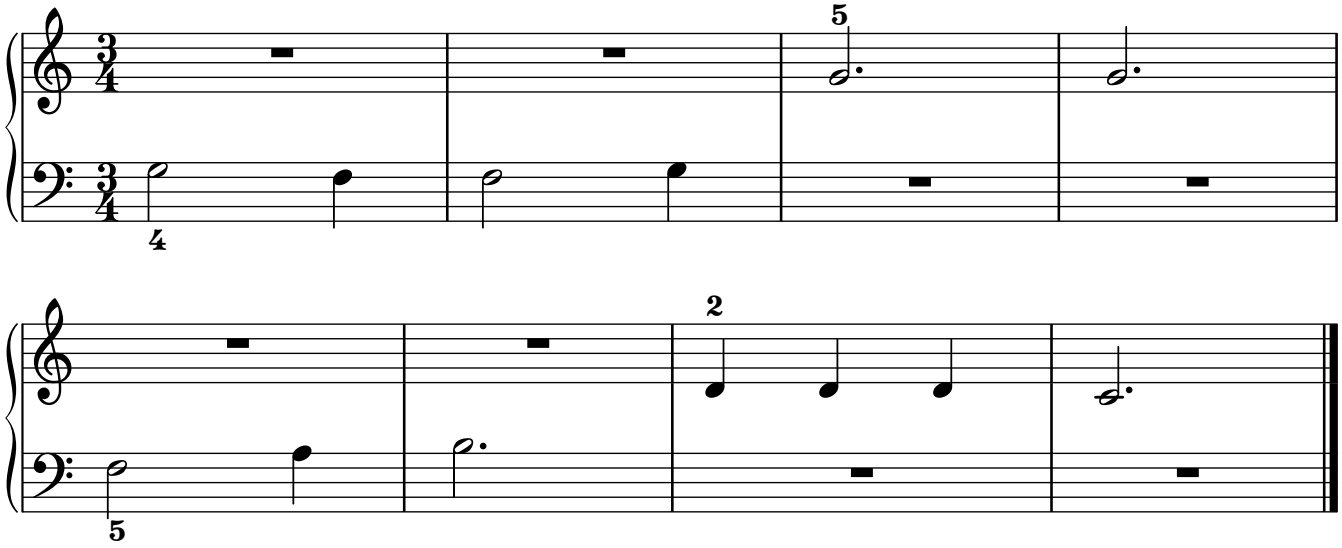
Part B: Longer phrases ♩ = 72

Eight-bar phrases in 3/4.

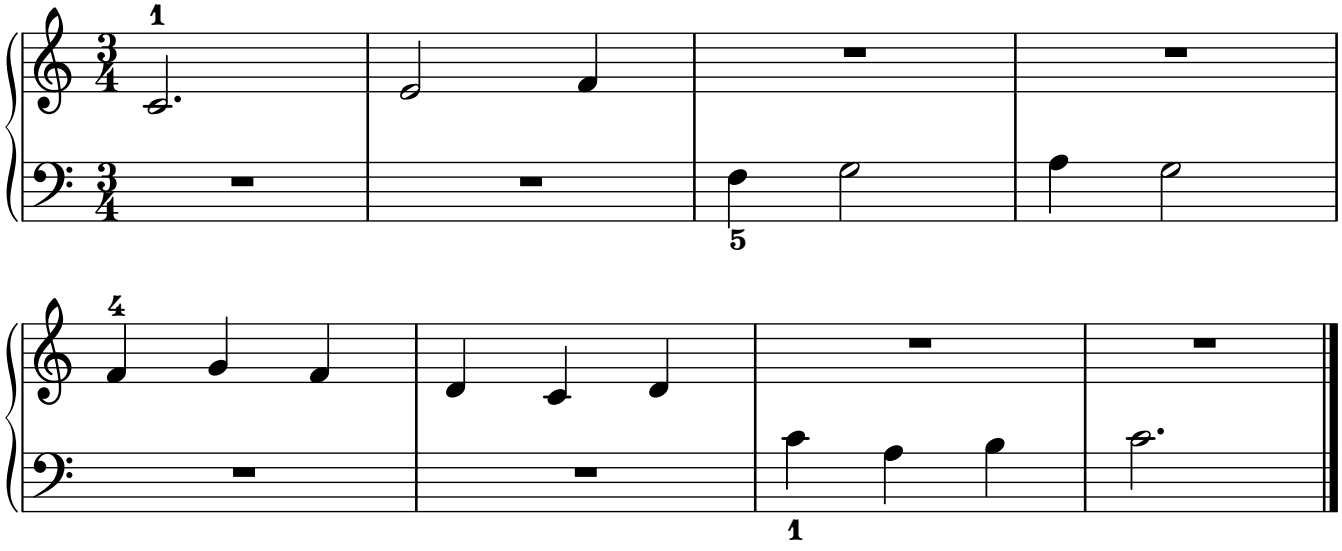
☐ **6.13**



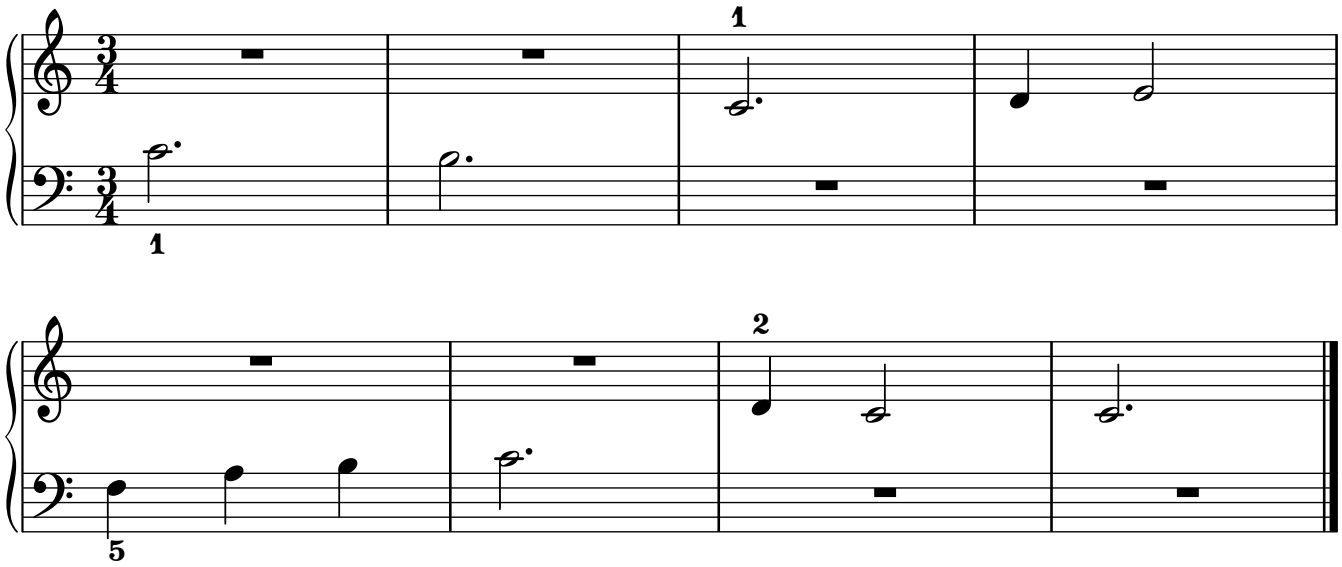
☐ **6.14**



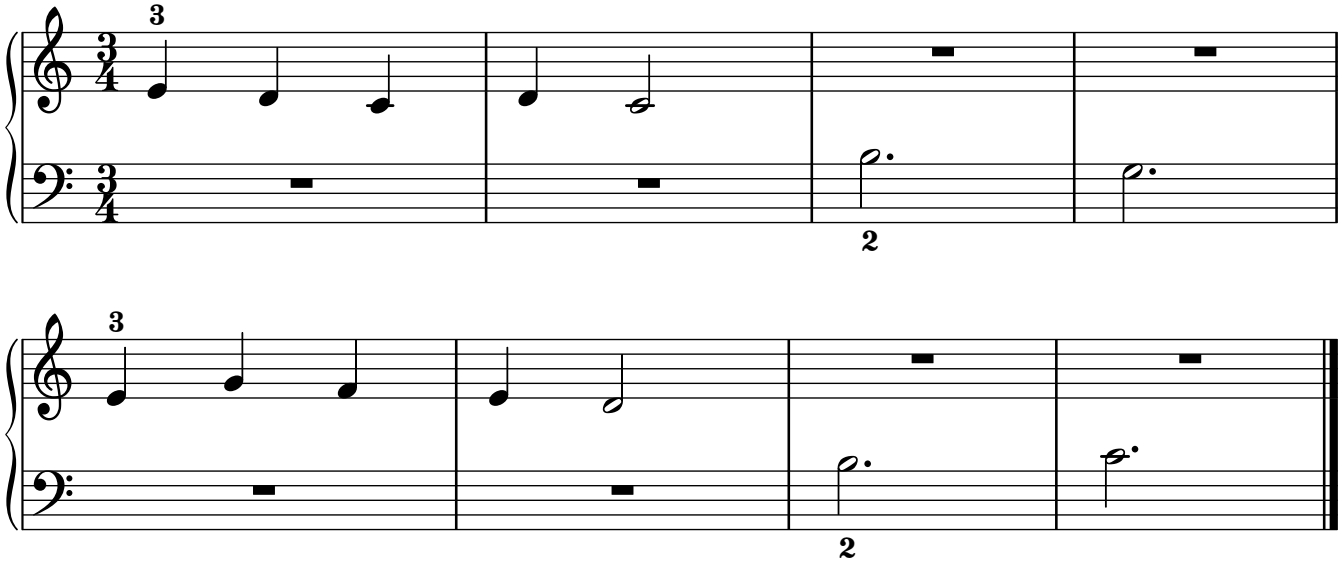
☐ **6.15**
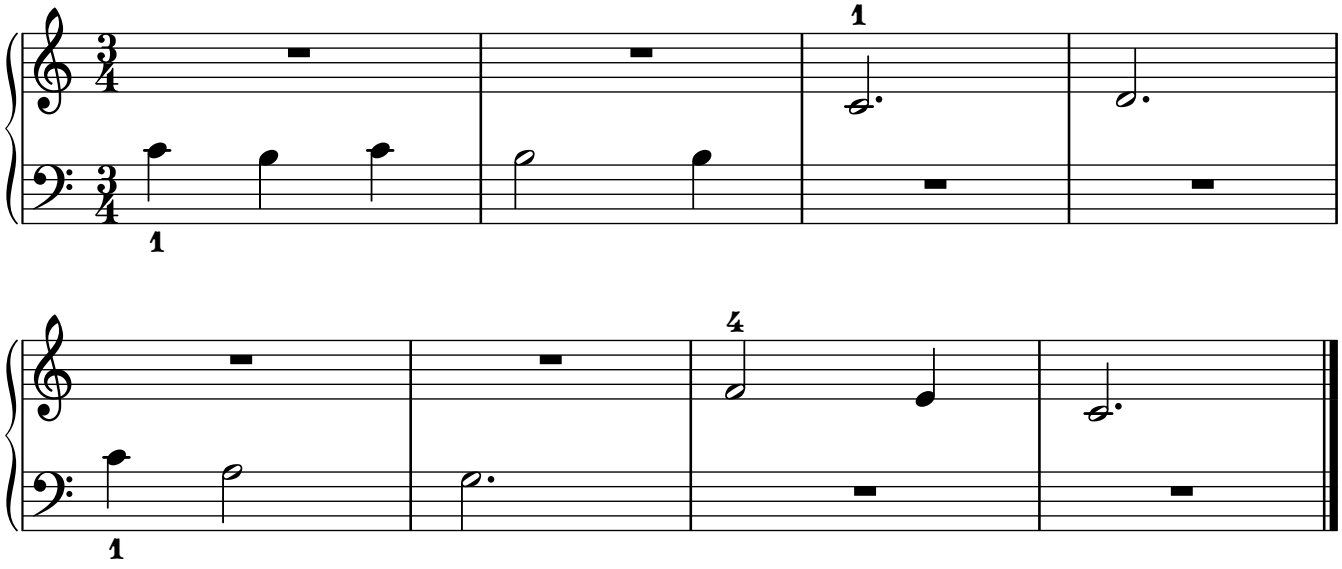


6.16



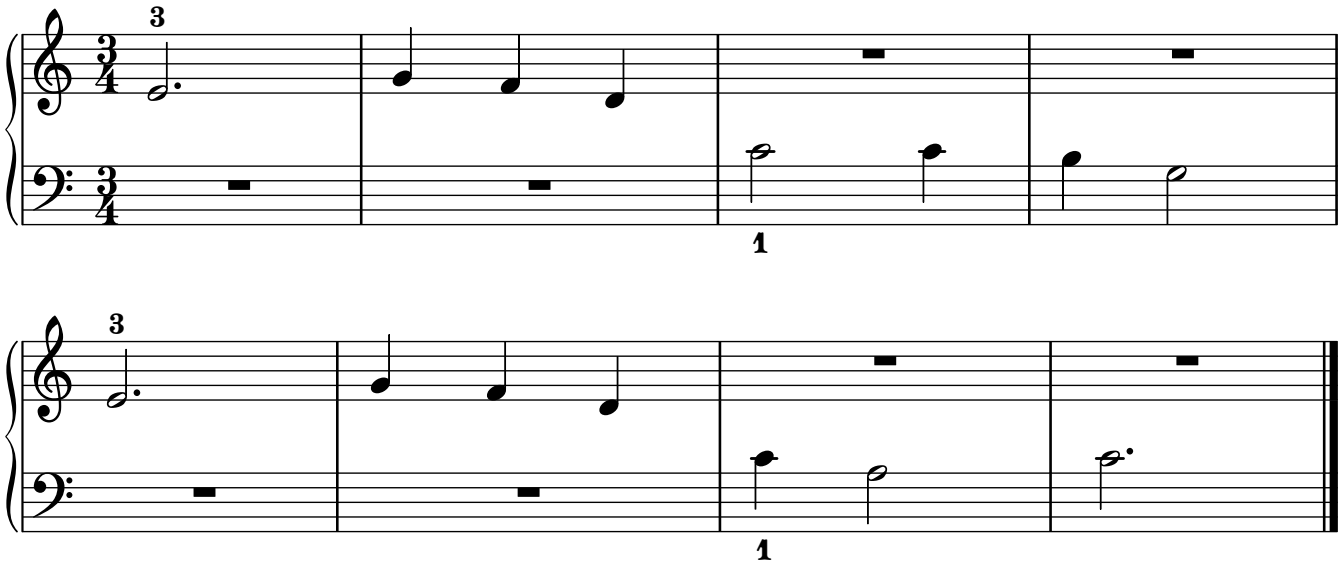
6.17
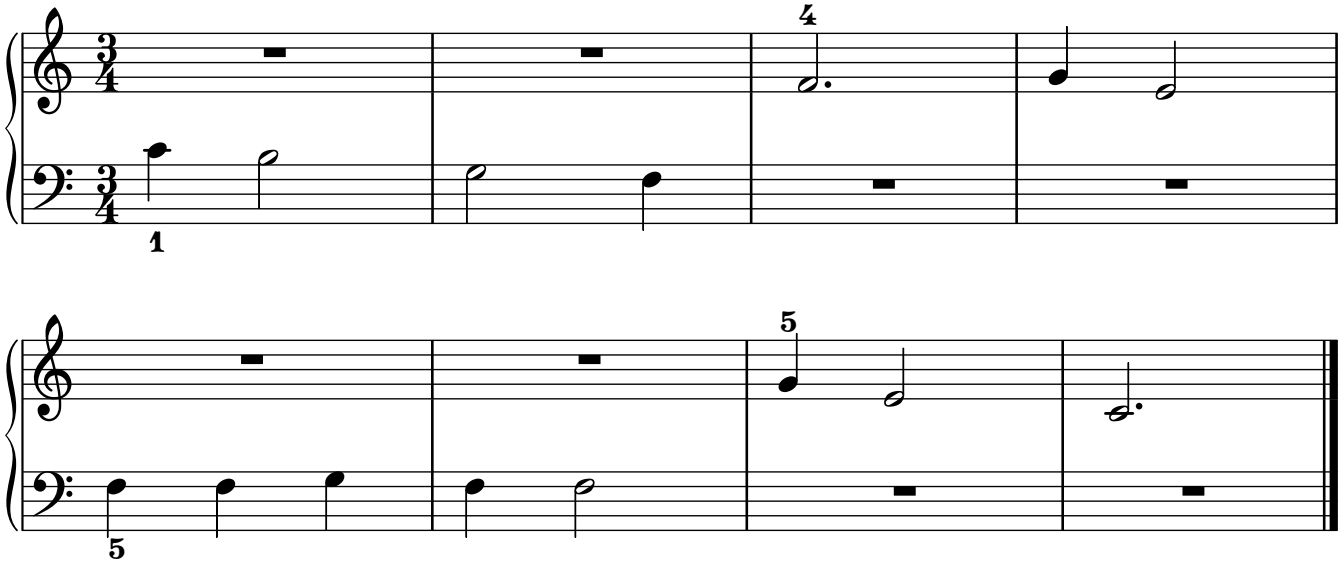


6.18
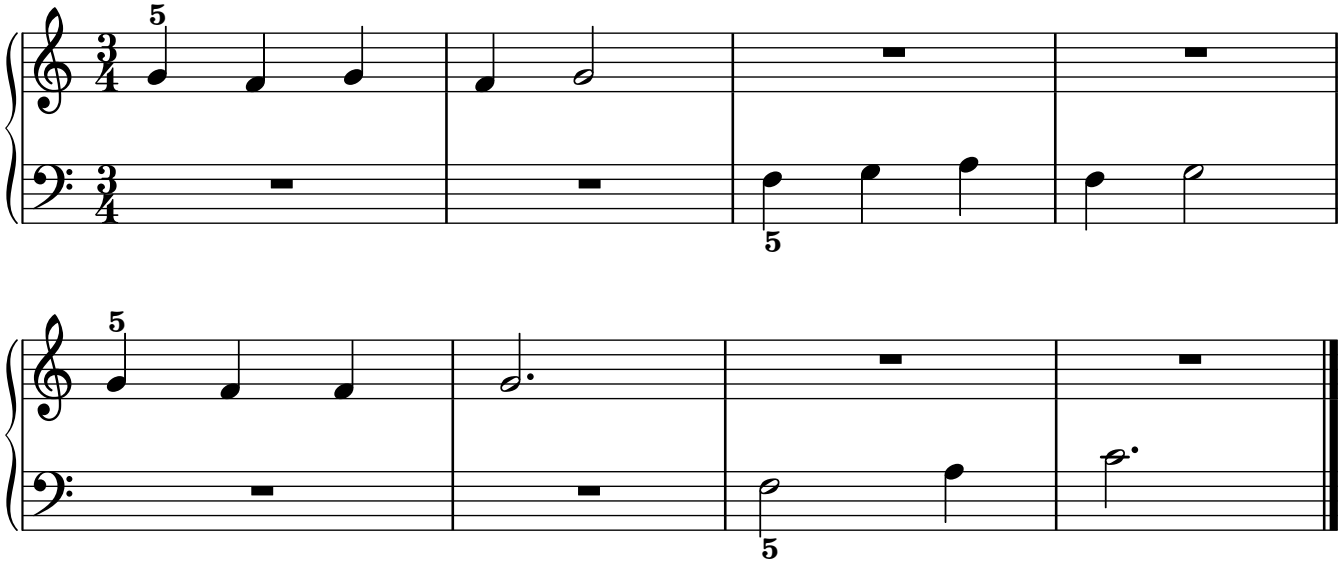


6.19
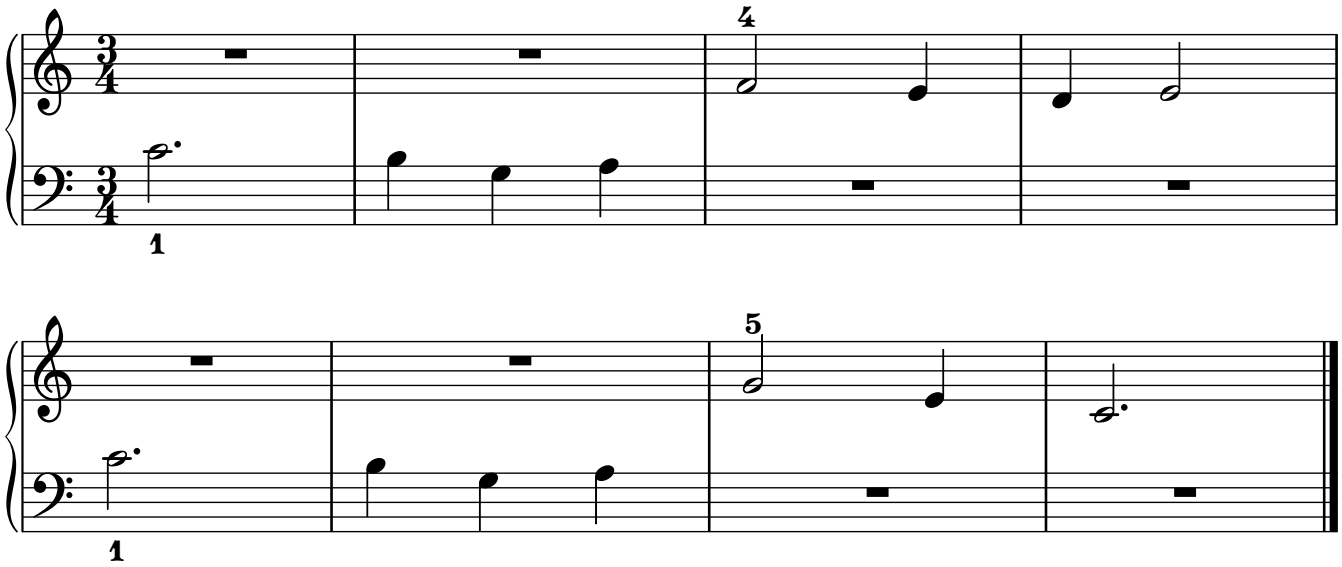


6.20



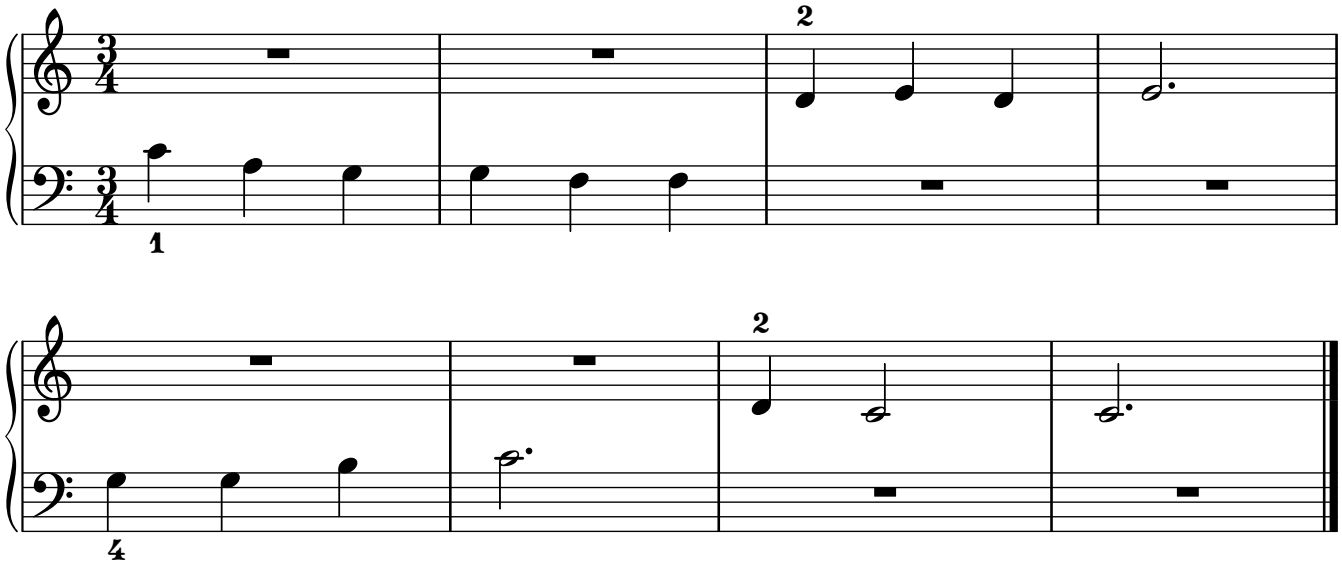
6.21
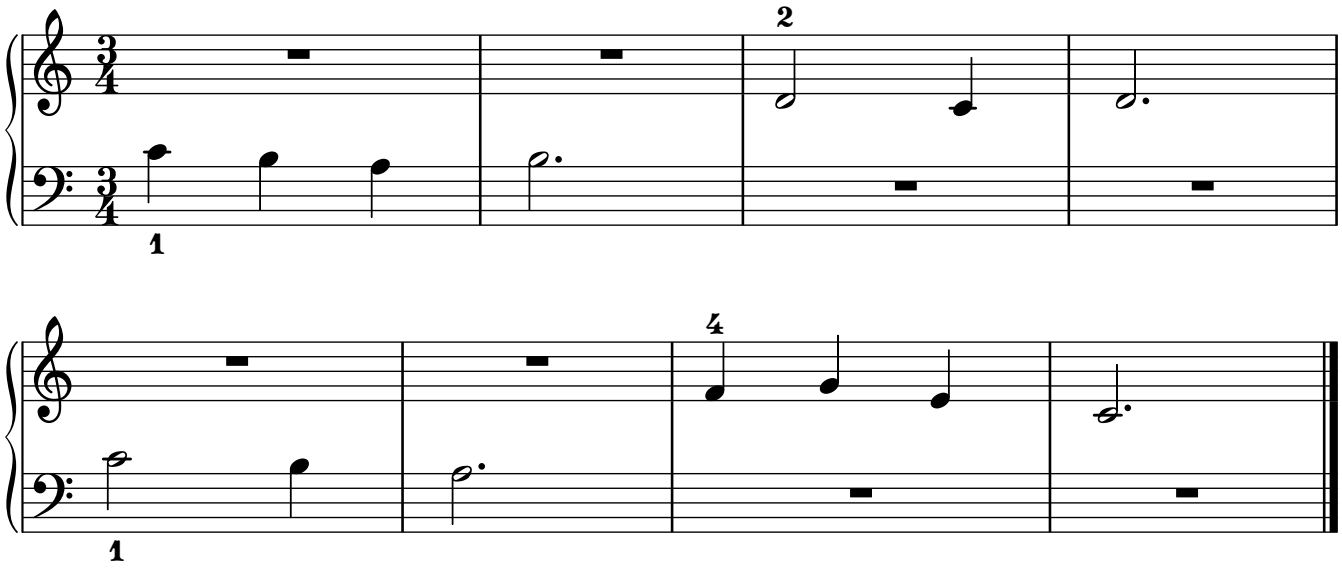


6.22



6.23



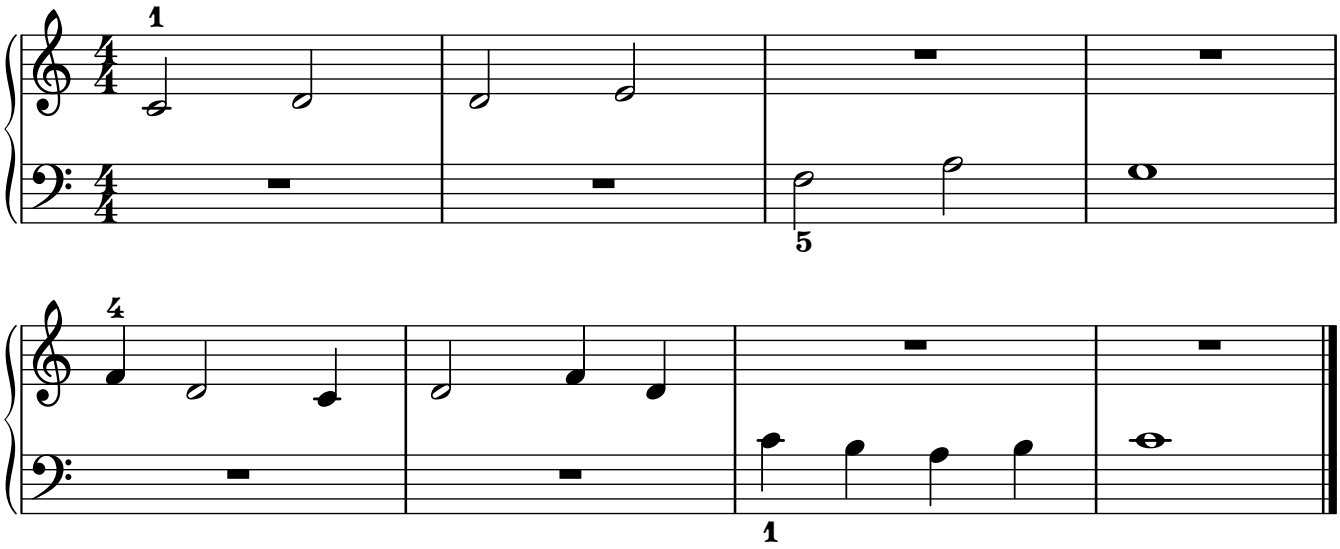
6.24



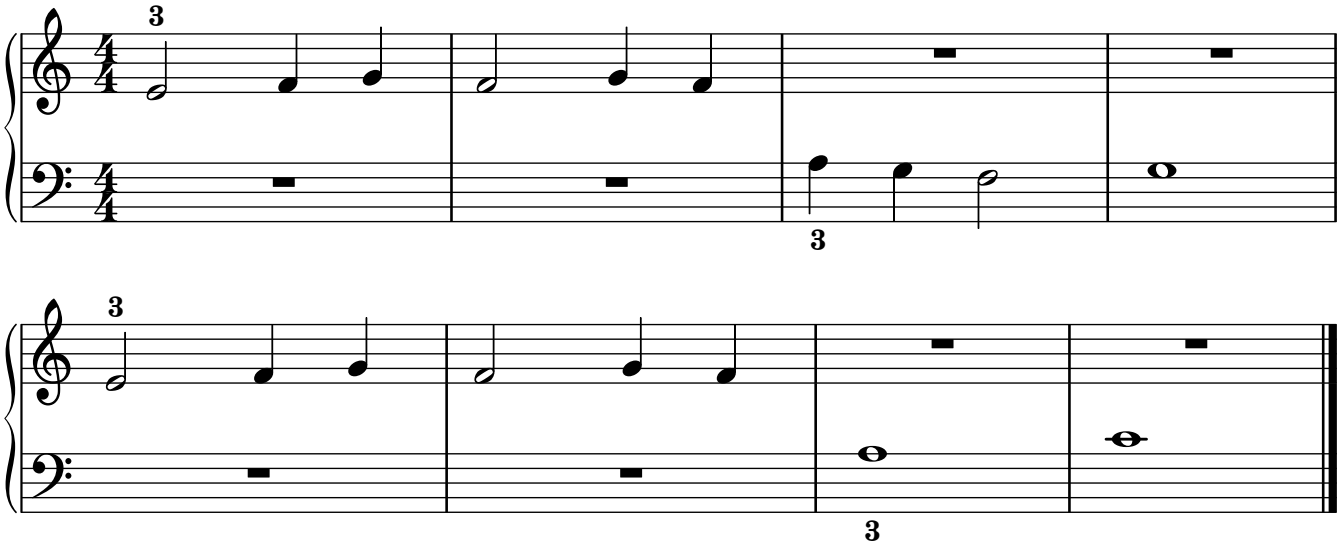
Part C: Eight bars in 4/4 ♩ = 66

Eight-bar phrases in 4/4, including whole notes and quarter-half-quarter rhythms.
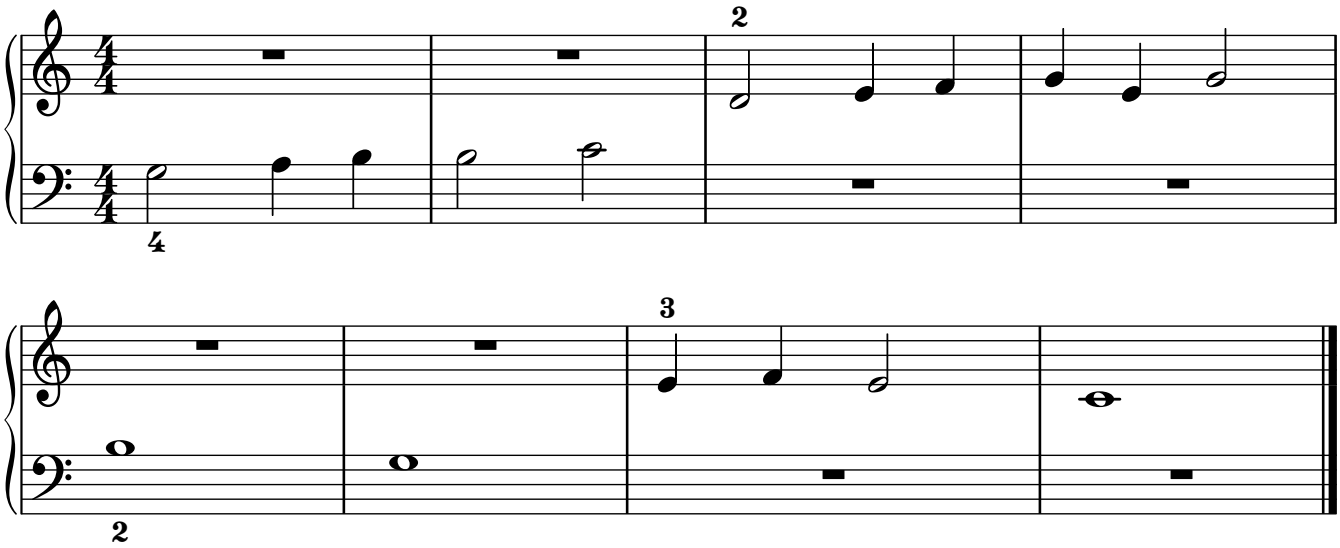
☐ **6.25**
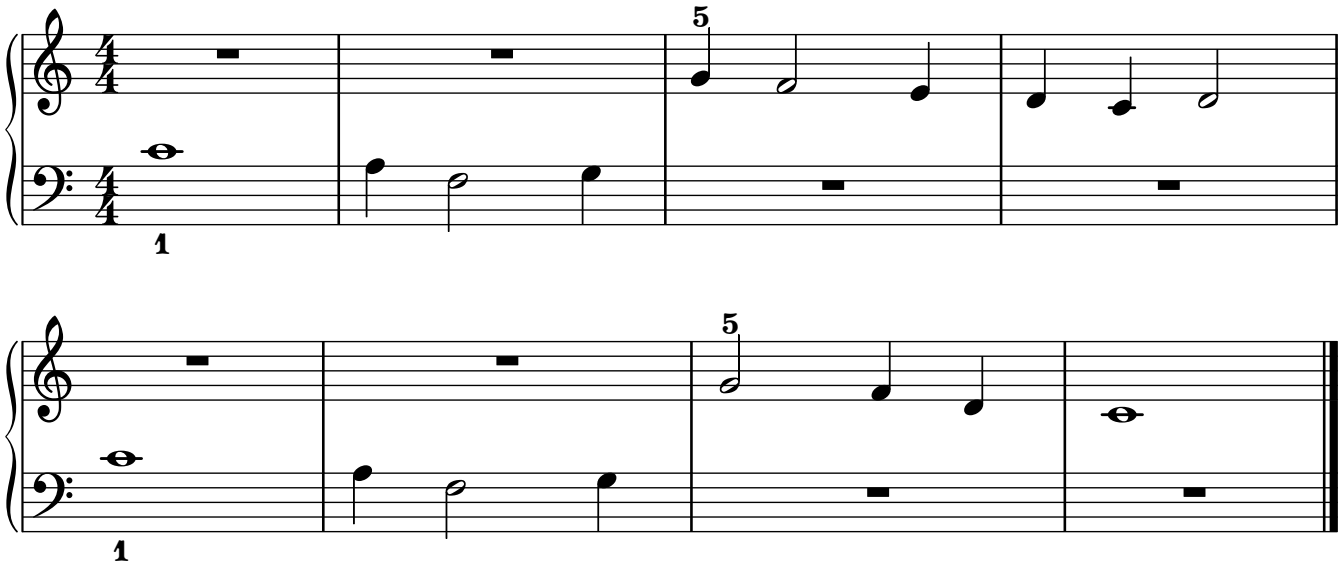


☐ **6.26**



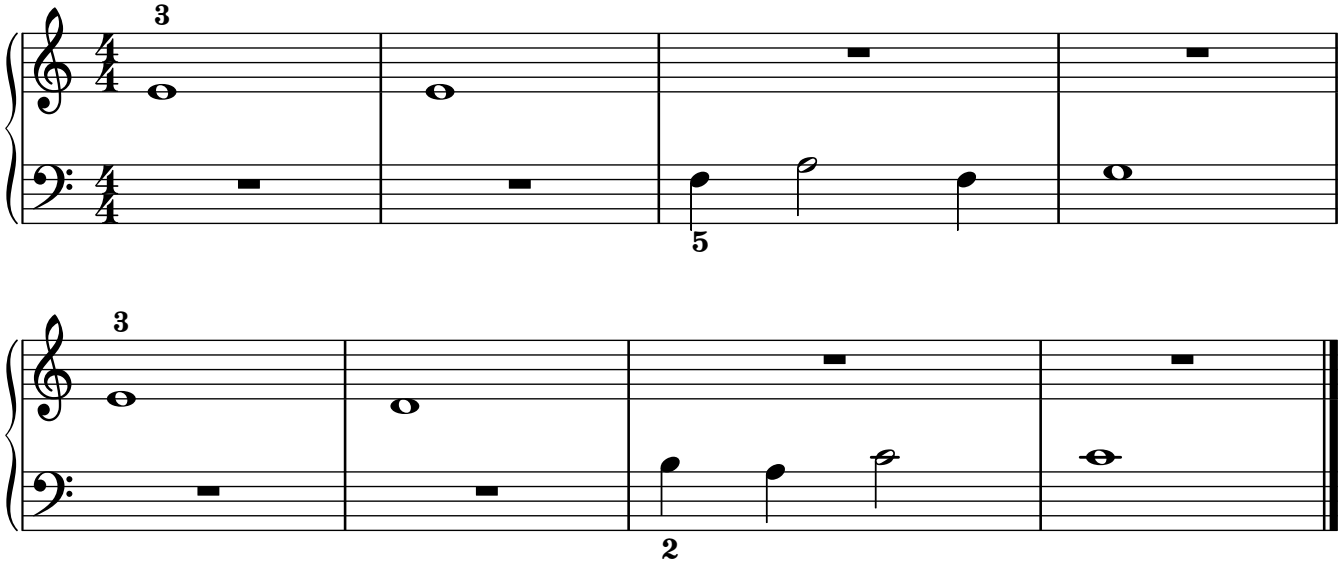
☐ **6.27**



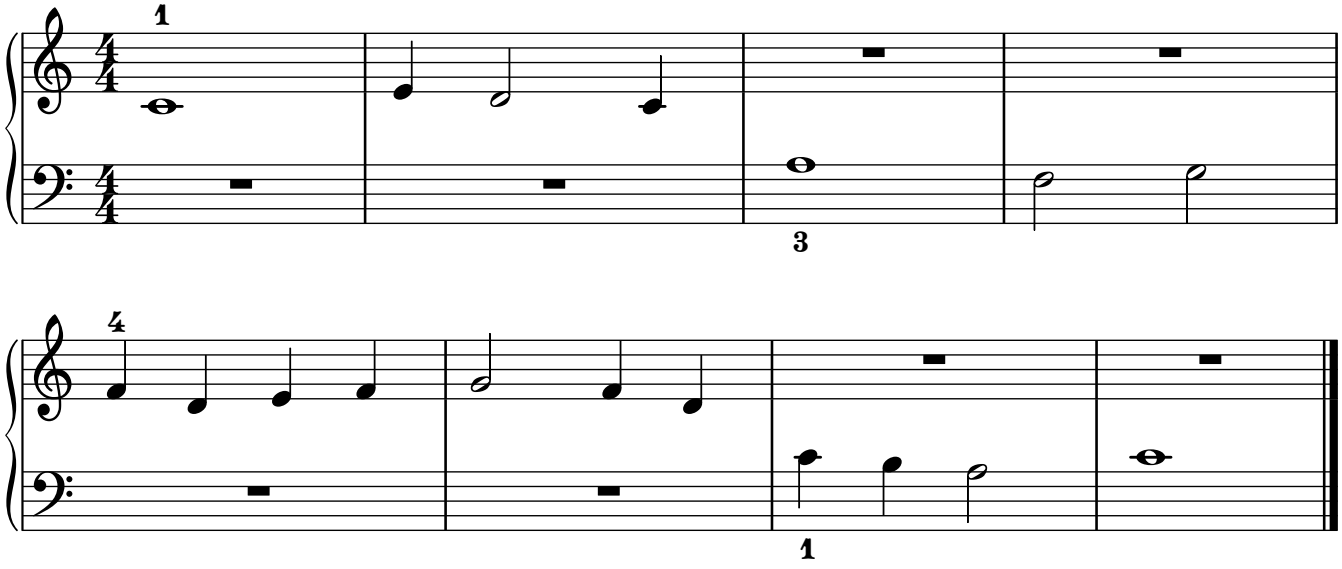
6.28



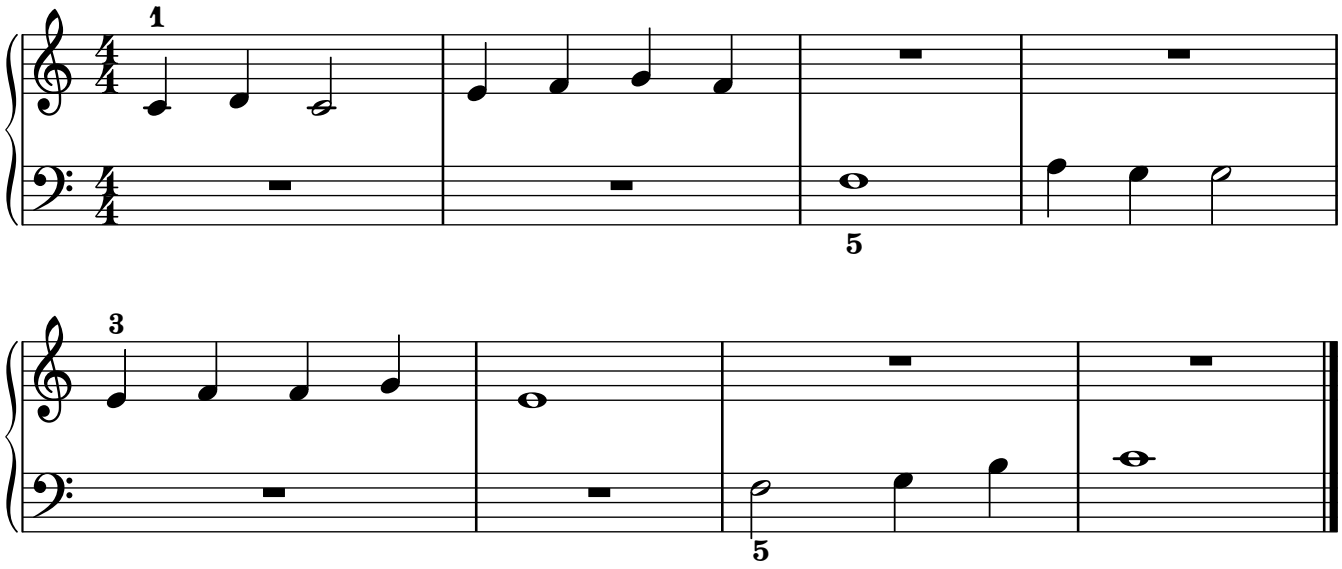
6.29



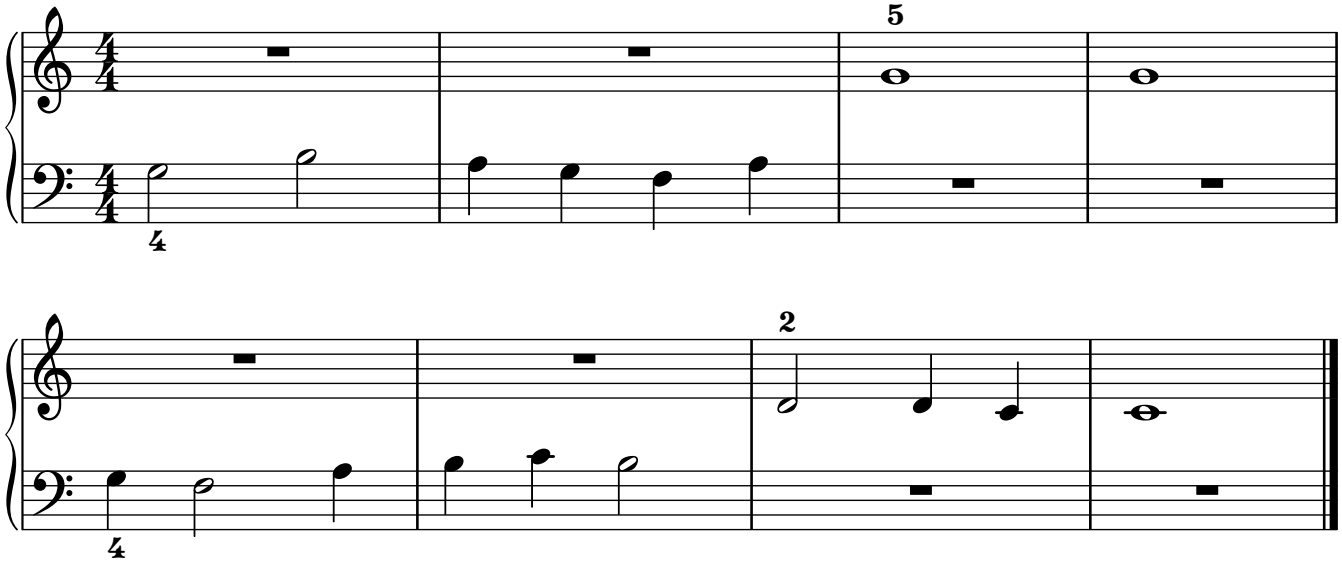
6.30



6.31



6.32
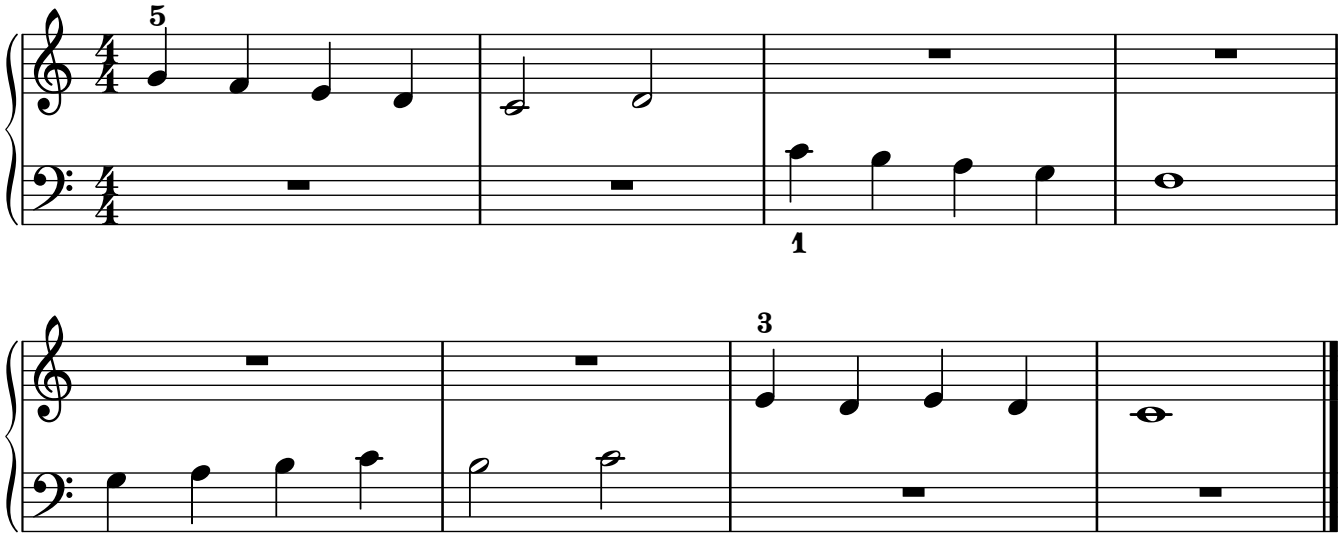


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Over the Bridge ♩ = 72

Original
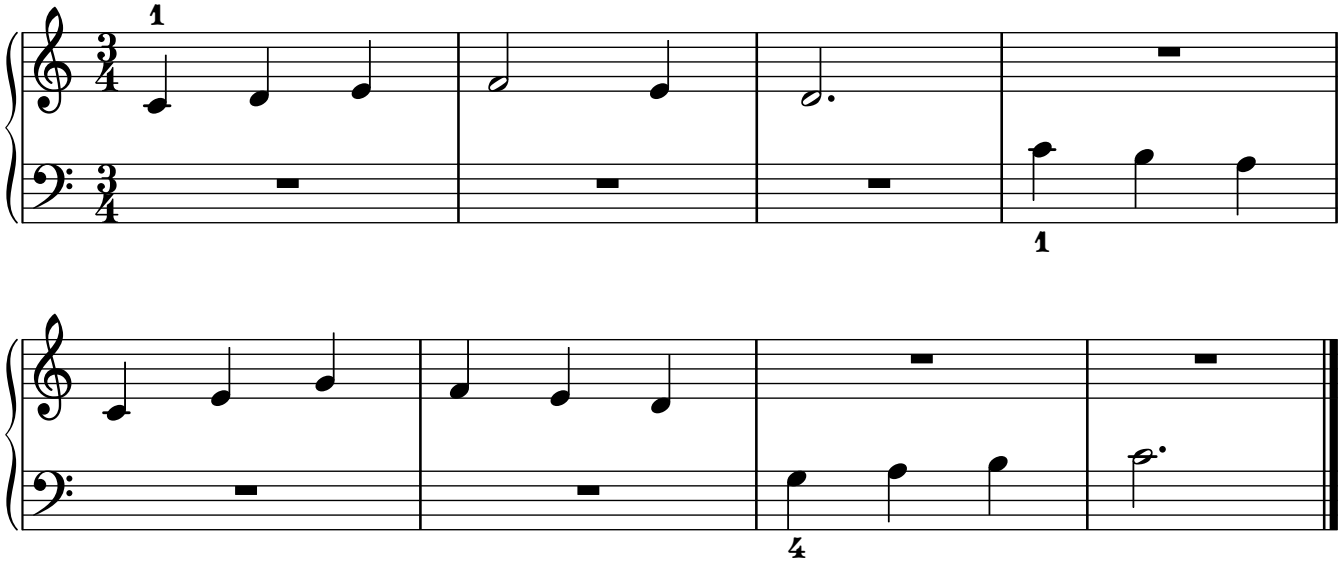
The tune walks down from the right hand, crosses middle C into the left hand, and comes back up again.



Sharing Middle C ♩ = 84

Original

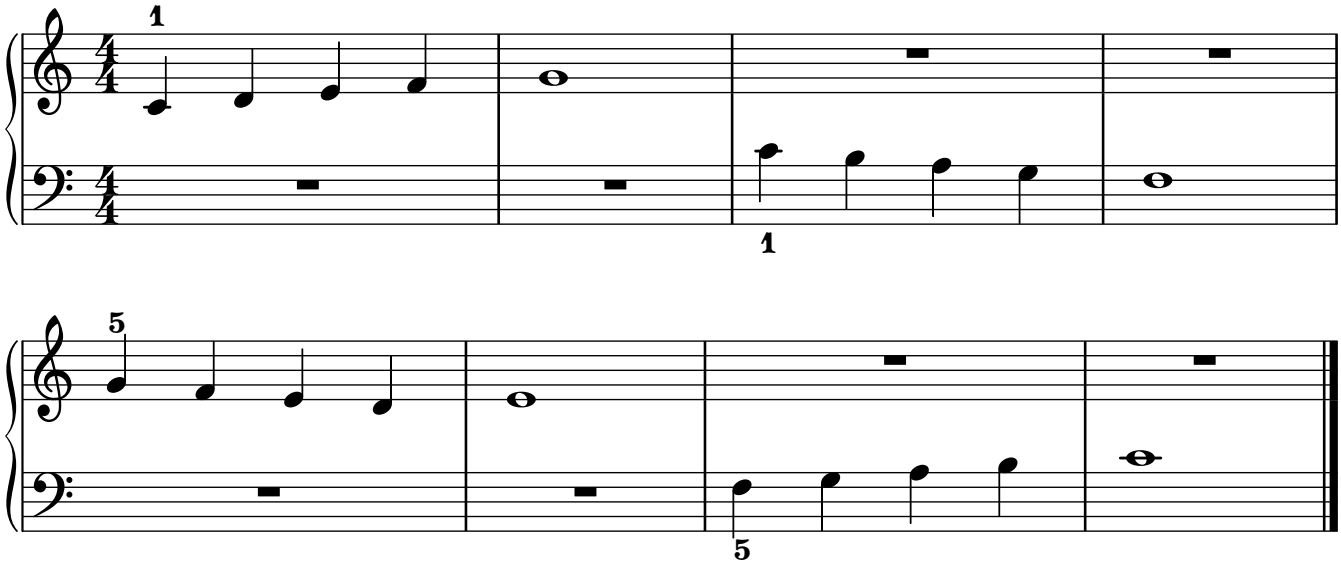
Both hands start on middle C. Watch which staff it is written on.



Echo Across Middle C ♩ = 76

Original

The right hand climbs, the left hand answers by stepping down from middle C, and the two hands meet on middle C at the end.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 7?

- Play five Part B or C exercises you have not played before, at the speed shown.
- Pass if you never hesitate over A, B or C at the top of the bass staff.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 7.